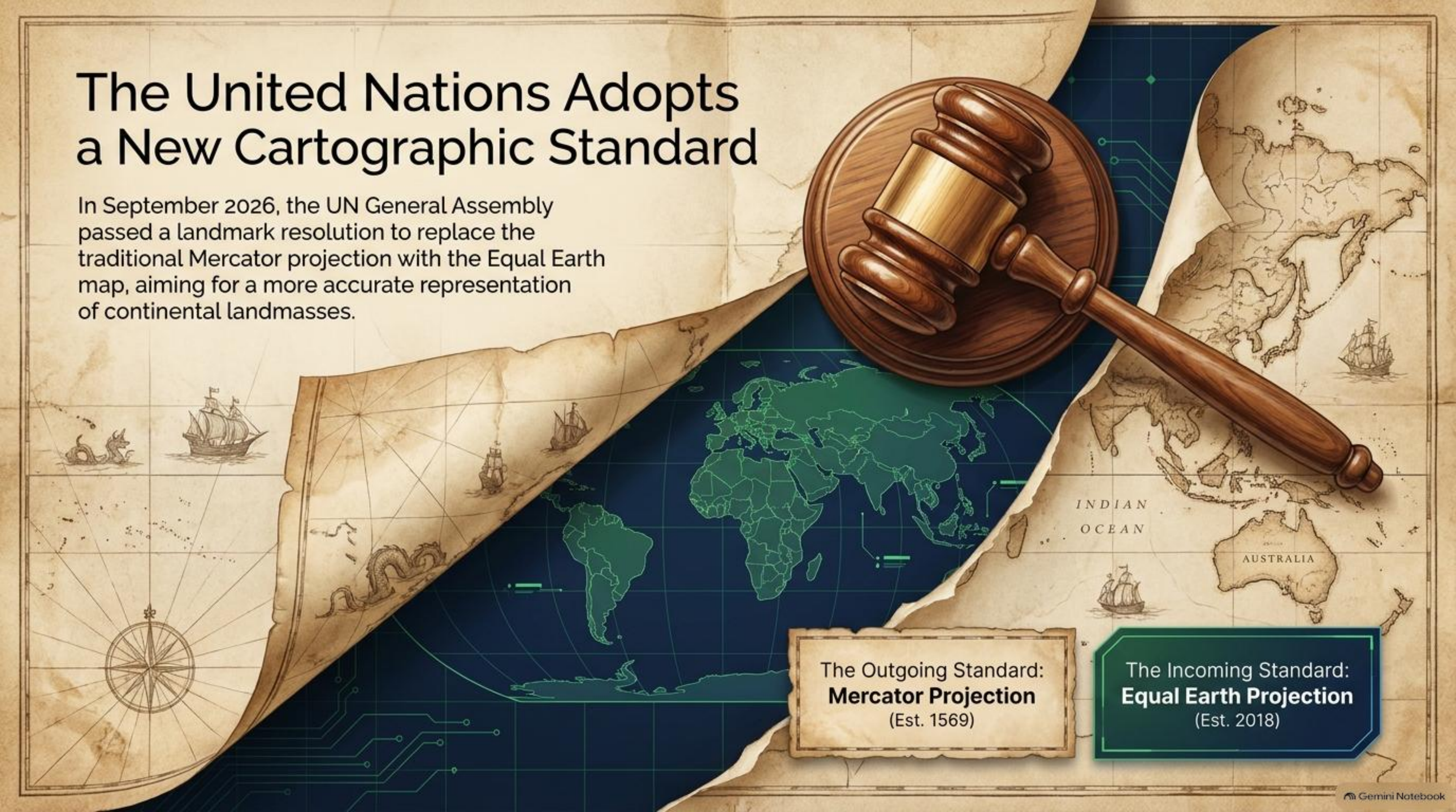
Redrawing the World

The 2026 UN Resolution to Abandon the Mercator Projection

Gemini Notebook

The United Nations Adopts a New Cartographic Standard

In September 2026, the UN General Assembly passed a landmark resolution to replace the traditional Mercator projection with the Equal Earth map, aiming for a more accurate representation of continental landmasses.

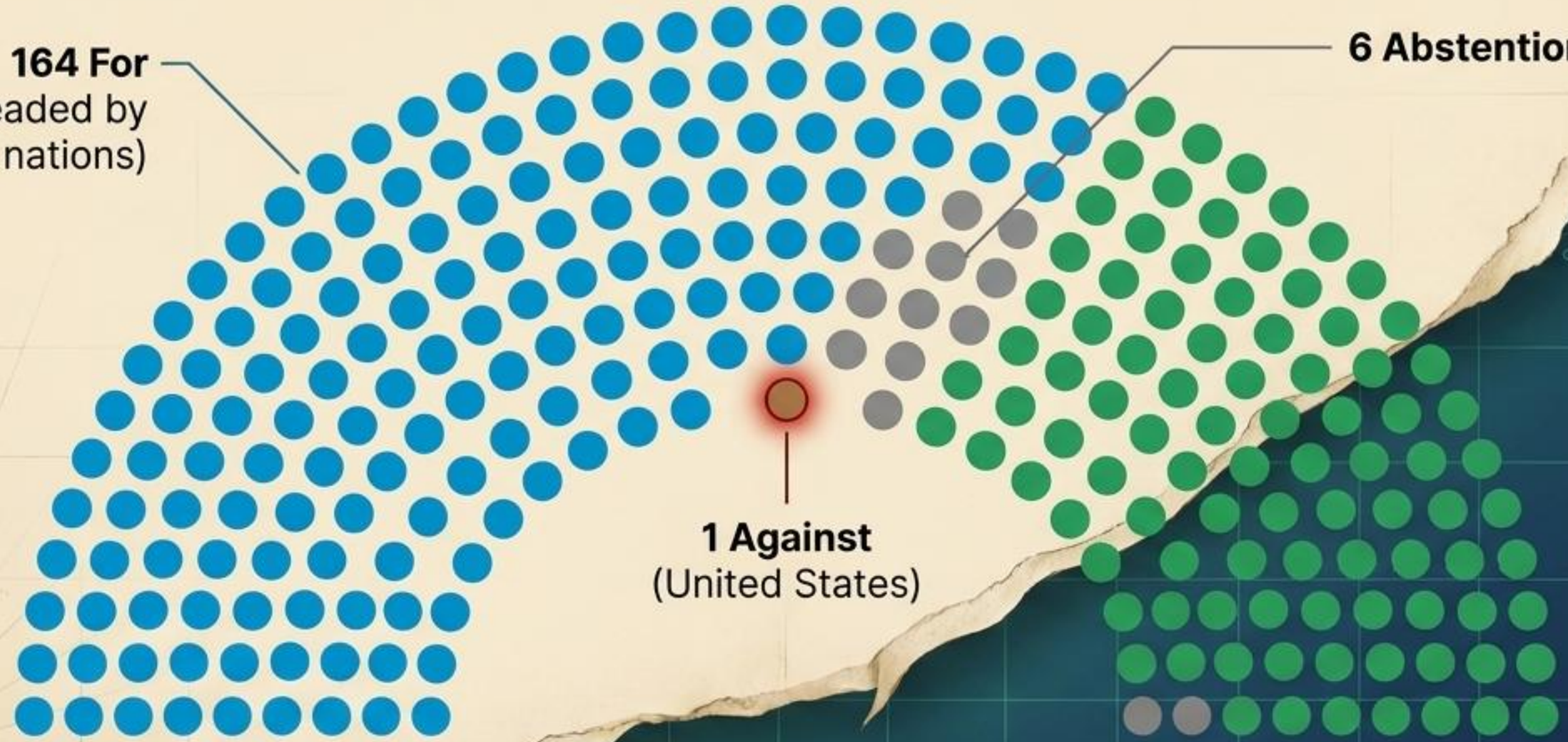


The Outgoing Standard:
Mercator Projection
(Est. 1569)

The Incoming Standard:
Equal Earth Projection
(Est. 2018)

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A Global Consensus with a Singular Dissent



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The 1569 Standard Built for Maritime Navigation



Designed by Flemish cartographer Gerardus Mercator, the projection prioritized accurate depictions of shapes and angles. This mathematical design allowed sailors to plot straight-line courses (rhumb lines) across oceans, a revolutionary tool for 16th-century global trade.

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The 3D to 2D Distortion Effect



To keep **maritime navigation angles** straight, the projection **artificially inflates northern regions** and compresses equatorial zones, severely distorting relative landmass sizes.

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The Illusion of Scale



Under the Mercator projection, Greenland and Africa appear to be roughly the same size. In reality, Africa is 14 times larger.

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The 2018 Correction via Equal Earth



"Equal Earth preserves the relative surface areas of continents and, as much as possible, shows their shapes as they appear on a globe."
— Bojan Savric, Cartographer (2025).

Launched by a group of cartographers in 2018, this projection restores visual equity to the Southern Hemisphere.

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Projection Diagnostic Matrix

	Mercator	Equal Earth
Era & Origin	1569 (Gerardus Mercator)	2018 (Bojan Savric & team)
Primary Purpose	Maritime Navigation (plotting straight courses)	Accurate Representation (true comparative scale)
Geometric Focus	Preserves Shapes & Angles	Preserves Relative Surface Area
Spatial Distortion	Inflates Poles, Compresses Equator	Proportional Continental Landmasses

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The Shifting Silhouettes



SHRINKING
(Poleward Inflation Reduced)



SHRINKING
(Reduced Distortion)



DRAMATIC SHRINKING
(Extreme Polar Inflation Corrected)



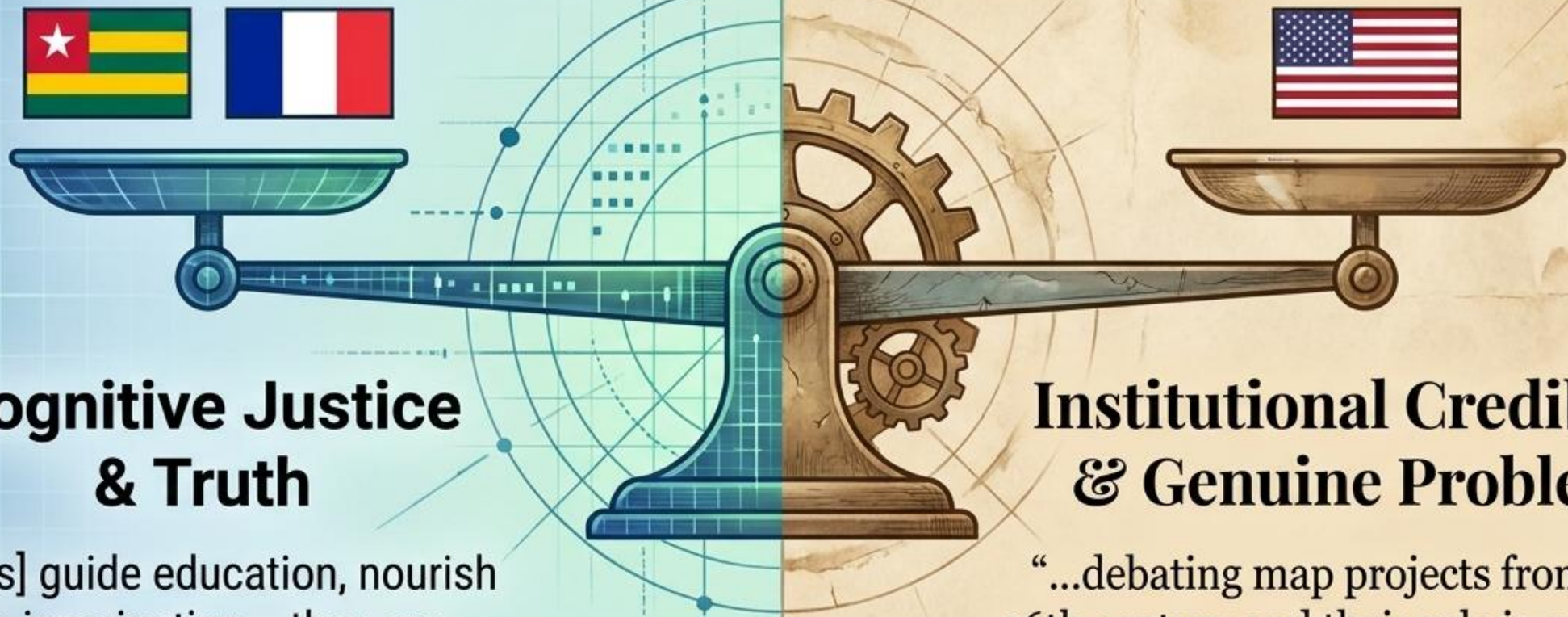
PROPORTIONAL EXPANSION
(True Area Revealed)



EXPANSION
(Visual Equity Restored)

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The Diplomatic Friction of Cartography



Cognitive Justice & Truth

"[Maps] guide education, nourish the imagination... they are therefore never neutral."

— Robert Dussey, Foreign Minister of Togo.

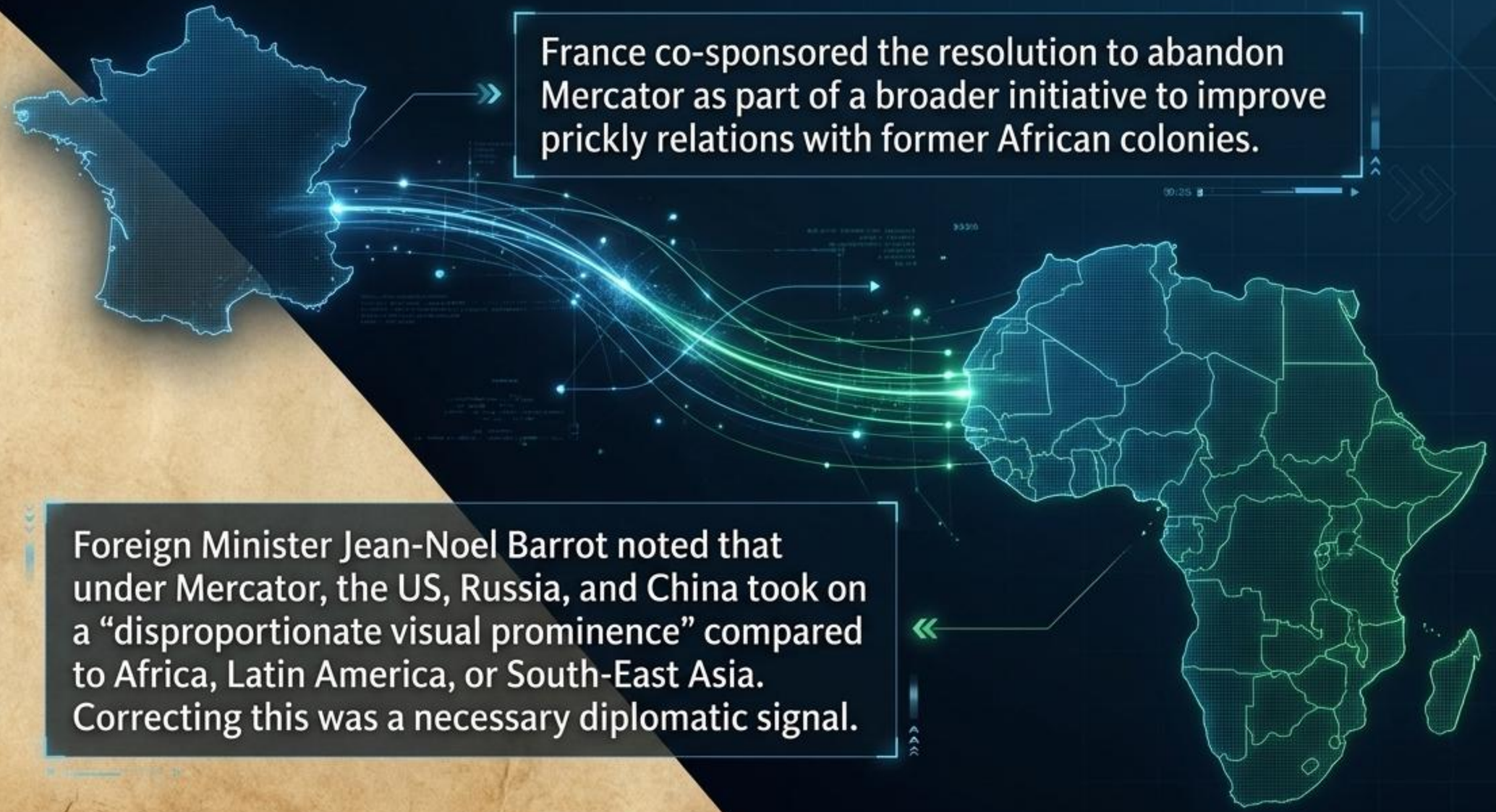
Institutional Credibility & Genuine Problems

"...debating map projects from the 16th century and their role in promoting reparations and cognitive justice."

— Yaryna Ferencevych, US Representative.

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Recalibrating Historical Ties



France co-sponsored the resolution to abandon Mercator as part of a broader initiative to improve prickly relations with former African colonies.

Foreign Minister Jean-Noel Barrot noted that under Mercator, the US, Russia, and China took on a “disproportionate visual prominence” compared to Africa, Latin America, or South-East Asia. Correcting this was a necessary diplomatic signal.

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Cartography as Diplomacy

The Math

Solving the 3D-to-2D geometric distortion.

The Mind

Addressing "Cognitive Justice" by removing the systemic inflation of the Global North.

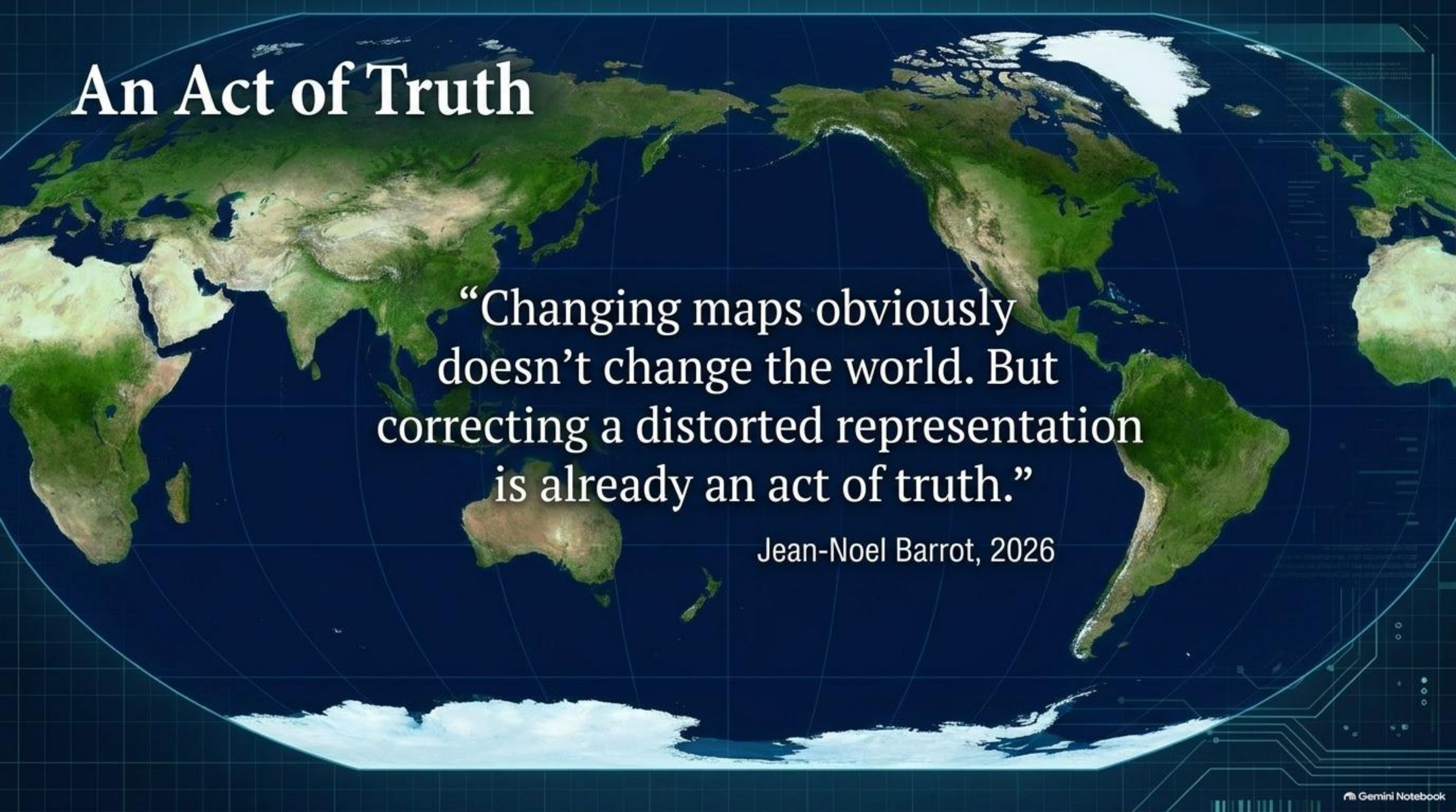
The Power

Shifting visual prominence away from a Eurocentric worldview to reflect the true physical weight of the Global South.

The **2026 UN resolution** proves that **global maps** are **not merely geographic** tools, but **active political instruments** that **shape international relations.**

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An Act of Truth



"Changing maps obviously doesn't change the world. But correcting a distorted representation is already an act of truth."

Jean-Noel Barrot, 2026

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